



THE INDIAN OCEAN AND THE NEARBY SEAS have the largest number of active fishermen in the world. International agreements determine how far into the Palk Straits—the body of water that separates Sri Lanka from India—fishermen from the respective countries may fish. There are disputes and violent, sometimes tragic, misunderstandings between fishermen out at sea in small boats from both countries. Meanwhile, closer to the shore, other fishermen simply wade out to their wooden perches and wait for the fish to come to them in the shallows. Nobody knows where this peculiar technique originated, but the spots are handed down from father to son and jealously guarded.

